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ACADEMIC EMPLOYMENT

Assistant Professor of Economics (tenure-track)

2021-Present

Hong Kong University of Science and Technology (HKUST)

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics

2021

University of California – Berkeley

Thesis Committee: Yuriy Gorodnichenko (chair), Andrés Rodríguez-Clare, Christina Romer

Credential ID: 211KOAXWM9SX [Show Credential](#)

Visiting Graduate Student

2014

Columbia University

M.Res. in Economics, Finance and Management

2013

Universitat Pompeu Fabra

M.Sc. in Economics and Finance

2012

Barcelona Graduate School of Economics

B.S. Economics (LLICENCIATURA)

2011

Universitat Pompeu Fabra

PREVIOUS APPOINTMENTS

Research Assistant with Prof. Yuriy Gorodnichenko

2016

University of California – Berkeley

Research Assistant with Prof. Antonio Ciccone

Summer 2011

Universitat Pompeu Fabra

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Macroeconomics, Finance, Banking, Fiscal and Monetary Policy, Economic History.

PEER-REVIEWED PAPERS

1. [M. Dordal i Carreras](#), O. Coibion, Y. Gorodnichenko, J. Wieland, “[Infrequent but Long-Lived Zero Lower Bound Episodes and the Optimal Rate of Inflation](#)”, *Annual Review of Economics* Vol. 8, 497-520 (2016).

– VOX EU, CEPR Policy Portal [Article](#).

Countries rarely hit the zero lower bound (ZLB) on interest rates, but when they do, these episodes tend to be very long-lived. These two features are difficult to incorporate jointly into macroeconomic models using typical representations of shock processes. We introduce a regime-switching representation of risk premium shocks into an otherwise standard New Keynesian model to generate a realistic distribution of ZLB durations. We discuss what different calibrations of this model imply for optimal inflation rates.

POLICY PAPERS

1. [M. Dordal i Carreras](#), HKUST SBM, HSBC, “e-HKD Pilot Programme”, *Policy Papers* (2023).

The e-HKD Pilot Programme is a key component of the HKMA’s three-rail approach in paving the way for a possible implementation of a retail central bank digital currency (CBDC). The pilot programme enables HKMA’s collaboration with the industry to examine innovative use cases and maximise Hong Kong’s readiness for a potential e-HKD. The Hongkong and Shanghai Banking Corporation Limited (HSBC) was one of the institutions selected to participate. Collaborating with the Hong Kong University of Science and Technology (HKUST), HSBC sought to explore possible e-HKD every-day payment use cases, focusing on programmability as a value-add feature of digital currency as well as payment rail efficiency. HSBC and HKUST constructed a one-week pilot on the HKUST campus, which included 148 students and 5 merchants. See: [e-HKD Pilot Programme Phase I Pilot Factsheet](#) and [e-HKD Pilot Programme Phase I Report](#).

WORKING PAPERS

1. [M. Dordal i Carreras](#), S. Joo Lee, “Higher-Order Forward Guidance”, *Working paper, Revise & Resubmit for Journal of Economic Theory* (2025).

This paper develops a business cycle model with endogenous financial volatility at the Zero Lower Bound (ZLB), highlighting forward guidance as a key mechanism for coordinating market behavior and improving welfare. We show that central banks can reduce excess volatility by credibly pledging future stabilization, or alternatively, by withholding such pledges to direct the economy toward favorable outcomes with lower volatility, revealing a trade-off. We also find that partial uncertainty about future

policy dominates strict commitments. Finally, fiscal measures that promote risky asset investments can boost economic activity at the ZLB by increasing aggregate household financial wealth.

2. M. Dordal i Carreras, M. Hoelzlein, J. Orben, “Efficiency, Risk and the Gains from Trade in Interbank Markets”, *Working Paper, Revise & Resubmit for Journal of International Economics* (2025).

We propose a model of the financial sector that captures complex relationships between highly heterogeneous agents in the market for loanable interbank funds and develops the bank-to-bank component of the macroeconomics financial transmission channel. Financial institutions trade funds due to heterogeneous capacity to provide liquidity, but trade is subject to frictions and uncertainty. The model provides a tractable framework to study the trade-off between efficiency and volatility in the financial sector, and its contribution to business cycles fluctuations.

3. M. Dordal i Carreras, K. Kawaguchi, S. Jin, H. Guo, “Consumer Perceptions and Willingness to Adopt rCBDCs Before and After the e-HKD Pilot”, *Working Paper, Revise & Resubmit for Distributed Ledger Technologies: Research and Practice* (2025).

This study investigates the public’s perception of retail Central Bank Digital Currency (rCBDC) and identifies the factors influencing its adoption. Conducted in collaboration with a prominent bank in Hong Kong, this research involved a hands-on experience with a prototype e-HKD payment system, a hypothetical version of the rCBDC for Hong Kong.

4. S. Joo Lee, M. Dordal i Carreras, “Yield-Curve Control Policy under Inelastic Financial Markets”, *Working Paper, Reject & Resubmit for Journal of Money, Credit and Banking* (2025).

We develop a New Keynesian framework that incorporates the term structure of financial markets, emphasizing the role of government and central bank balance sheet composition in monetary policy transmission. Our model accounts for microfounded market segmentation across asset classes and maturities based on finite and estimable asset demand elasticities. We show that unconventional policy interventions, such as large-scale asset purchase programs and yield-curve control policies, effectively stabilize the economy during normal periods and at the zero lower bound, albeit by extending ZLB episodes and reducing the efficacy of future short-term rate adjustments.

5. M. Dordal i Carreras, S. Joo Lee, Z. Qi, “Endogenous Firm Entry and the Monetary Policy ‘Room’”, *Working Paper, Reject & Resubmit for European Economic Review* (2025).

We present a business cycle model featuring endogenous firm entry. Entry-induced short-run shifts in supply shape the economy’s response to both supply and demand shocks. In particular, rising aggregate demand spurs entry, expanding supply and reinforcing demand through entrants’ investment expenditures. Monetary policy influences both aggregate demand and the entry decisions of financially constrained firms, shaping cycle dynamics in economies with high entry potential. Equilibrium firm entry is characterized by the “policy room”, a sufficient statistic for monetary policy effectiveness in both the model and empirical data.

6. S. Joo Lee, M. Dordal i Carreras, “Self-fulfilling Volatility and a New Monetary Policy”, *Working Paper, submitted* (2025).

We demonstrate that macroeconomic models with nominal rigidities feature multiple global solutions supporting alternative equilibria traditionally overlooked in the literature. In these equilibria, conventional Taylor rules give rise to self-fulfilling aggregate volatility, propelling the economy into crises (booms) characterized by elevated (reduced) aggregate risk. This outcome stems from the inability of conventional

rules to target the expected growth rate of output, which is determined not only by the policy rate but also by the strength of the precautionary savings channel. We propose a new policy rule that targets both conventional mandates and aggregate volatility, reestablishing determinacy and achieving full stabilization.

7. M. Dordal i Carreras, S. Joo Lee, “The Spatial Transmission of US Banking Panics: Evidence from 1870-1929”, *Working Paper*, submitted (2025).

We study the propagation of localized banking panics across the United States, employing digitized state-level balance sheet data on the National Banks for the 1870-1929 period. Geographically localized panics result in the robust spillover outside the state borders where they originate, leading to moderately persistent credit contractions and the accumulation of liquid assets. We provide a tractable model illustrating a key trade-off: while interbank markets, e.g., the pyramidal reserve structure of the banking system during the National Banking Era, allow banks to access cheaper funding, they spread the effects of panics throughout the country as observed in the data.

8. M. Dordal i Carreras, C. Xiang, “Gender Gap, Structural Change and Female Comparative Advantage: A Quantitative Analysis of China”, *Working Paper* (2025).

This paper examines the decline in female labor force participation (LFP) in developing countries by linking structural change to female comparative advantage (CA). Our model predicts that female LFP decreases when women’s CA is concentrated in contracting sectors and increases when it shifts to expanding sectors. In many developing economies, the CA often resides in the shrinking agricultural sector. We validate the framework using Chinese census data, demonstrating its ability to explain regional female LFP variations and gender gaps in LFP, and further apply it to India to illustrate its broader predictive utility.

IN PROGRESS

1. M. Dordal i Carreras, K. Kawaguchi, S. Jin, “Informational Experiment on Consumer’s Perception of Central Bank Digital Currency as Liquidity Assets”, *In Progress* (2025).
2. M. Dordal i Carreras, O. Coibion, Y. Gorodnichenko, C. Howes, “What Do We Learn From Reading Every FOMC Transcript?”, *In Progress* (2025).

RESEARCH GRANTS, HONORS, AND AWARDS

- Research Grants Council, Early Career Scheme (ECS), Project #: 26603022, “Fed ”Influencers”: How individual characteristics and charisma affect FOMC policy decisions”, Funding: HK\$854,550 (2023-2025).
- Doctoral Completion Fellowship, UC Berkeley (2019).
- Bank of Spain Study Grant, Bank of Spain (2016).
- BEHL 2nd Year Student Mentored Fellowship, Berkeley Economics History Laboratory (2015).
- “La Caixa” Foundation Scholarship for graduate studies and research in the USA, “La Caixa” Foundation (2012).

- Teaching Assistantship Grant, Economics and Business Department, Universitat Pompeu Fabra (2011).
- Award to the top ten academic transcripts of the cohort, Economics and Business Department, Universitat Pompeu Fabra (2011).
- Collaboration Grant, Spanish Ministry of Education (2010).

REFeree

American Economic Review ($\times 2$); Journal of Monetary Economics ($\times 3$); The Review of Economics and Statistics; Pacific Economic Review.

M.Phil. Thesis Advisor

Yueqi Wu; Hongwei Zou; Kehui Leng; Chen (Cassie) Xiang.

M.Phil. Thesis Committee Member

Yueqi Wu; Kehui Leng; Hongwei Zou; Qichao Wang; Minjie Ding; Jinyuqi Huang; Chen (Cassie) Xiang.

Ph.D. Student Supervision

- Zhenghua QI (co-supervisor), [webpage](#).
- Chen (Cassie) XIANG (main supervisor), [webpage](#).
- Hongwei ZOU (main supervisor).
- Yueqi WU (co-supervisor).

Ph.D. Thesis Committee Member

Zhenghua QI; Xiang SHI; Ding DONG; Jun YU; Hei Chun (Alvin) LO.

Teaching

@ HKUST, Economics Dept.:

- Spring 22, Fall 22-24: Econ 2123 Macroeconomics.
- Fall 21-24: Econ 5250 Macroeconomic Theory I.
- Fall 22, Summer 24, Spring 25: ECON 6980-R1 (UG/M.Sc. Research project advisor).

SERVICE AND LEADERSHIP

- Member, Postgraduate Committee, Economics Department, *HKUST* (2023-Present).
- Co-organizer, Macro Reading group and Research Postgraduate Student Workshop, *HKUST* (2022-Present).
- Session moderator, Asian Economic Development Conference (AEDC 2026), *HKUST and Asian Development Bank* (2026).

CONFERENCES, EVENTS & SEMINARS (* BY CO-AUTHORS)

- **2026** - Center for Economic Policy Brown Bag Seminar, HKUST*; University of Tokyo Game Theory Workshop 2026; Peking University HSBC Business School; 2026 Asian Meeting of the Econometric Society (AMES 2026), HKU; 9th HKUST/Jinan Joint Macro Workshop; Conference on Law & Economics and Industrial Organization, HKUST*; The Eighth China International Conference in Macroeconomics (CICM 2026), Jilin University; 38th Asian Finance Association Conference (AsianFA 2026), Seoul.
- **2025** - Macau Workshop on International Macro and Finance; CESifo Money Macro and International Finance*; Universitat de Girona; 2025 World Congress of the Econometric Society (ESWC 2025); The Seventh China International Conference in Macroeconomics (CICM 2025); 2025 Annual Meeting Society for Economic Dynamics (SED 2025); ASIFMA Annual Conference 2025; EAYE Annual Conference 2025*; Yonsei University; Ewha Womans University*; Korea University*; RES 2025 Annual Conference*; Center for Economic Policy Brown Bag Seminar, HKUST.
- **2024** - IV Winter Workshop, Societat d'Economia Catalana; 2024 European Winter Meeting of the Econometric Society (EWMES 2024), Universitat de les Illes Balears; Econometric Society Australasian Meetings (ESAM2024), Monash University; International Macro History Online Seminar Series (IMHOS - Graduate Institute's Centre for Finance and Development and CEPR)*; London Juniors Finance Workshop (Imperial College London)*; Saïd Business School Finance Jamboree*; 2024 Asia Meeting of the Econometric Society in China (AMES2024-China), Zhejiang University; 7th HKUST/Jinan Joint Macro Workshop; 2024 Asia Meeting of the Econometric Society, East & Southeast Asia (AMES-E/SE) (declined); CREI-UPF Macroeconomics Seminar; 2024 Annual Meeting Society for Economic Dynamics (SED2024)*; 2024 Econometric Society North America Summer Meeting (NASM2024)*; 39th European Economic Association Meeting (EEA-ESEM-2024)*; International Conference on Central Bank Digital Currencies and Payment Systems, HKMA, AoF/HKIMR and HKUST; Center for Economic Policy Brownbag seminar, HKUST.
- **2023** - Tsinghua School of Economics and Management; East Asia Macroeconomics Conference, CUHK; Asia Meeting of the Econometric Society (AMES Singapore), NTU Singapore; 6th HKUST/Jinan Joint Macro Workshop; 11th Meeting of the Hong Kong Junior Macro Group; Third Catalan Economic Society Conference (CESC); 6th CEBRA Meeting, Abu Dhabi*; Notre Dame Macro Day*; UT Austin - McCombs (finance)*; Oxford (economics department's macro seminar)*.
- **2022** - 5th HKUST/Jinan Joint Macro Workshop; 5th Meeting of the Hong Kong Junior Macro Group; PAELLA Conference, Notre Dame*; London School of Economics*; Cana-

dian Economics Association Meetings (CEA 2022)*; Oxford Saïd – Risk Centre at ETH Zürich Macro-Finance Conference 2022 (at Oxford)*; The University of Hong Kong (macro)*; Princeton (macro internal)*; Princeton (finance internal)*.

- **2021** - UC Berkeley (macro lunch, GEMS); PUC Chile*; Federal Reserve Board of Governors (Financial Stability Division and International Finance Division)*; University of Oxford - Saïd (finance)*; The University of Hong Kong (macro)*; NYU - Stern and NYU - Shanghai (finance)*; Bank of Canada*.
- **2020** - UC Berkeley (macro lunch, GEMS); Notre Dame Macro Seminar*.

CONFERENCE PAPER DISCUSSANT

- 38th Asian Finance Association Conference (AsianFA 2026), discussant for “Chasing Alpha Under Uncertainty? International Evidence on Flow-Performance Sensitivity” by Sara Ali, Ihsan Badshah, Riza Demirer, and Prasad Hegde (2026).
- The Eighth China International Conference in Macroeconomics (CICM 2026), discussant for “On the Optimal Level of Stablecoins (and CBDC)” by Wei Cui, Jianjun Miao, and Yu Zhu (2026).
- The Sixth China International Conference in Macroeconomics (CICM2024), discussant for “A Macroeconomic Model with Bond Market Liquidity” by Huifeng Chang (2024).
- EFG and CUHK(SZ) Joint Macro Workshop on “Expectations, Information Frictions and Economic Policy”, discussant for “Inflation Disagreement Weakens the Power of Monetary Policy” by Ding Dong, Zheng Liu, Pengfei Wang, and Min Wei (2024).
- HKUST/Jinan Joint Macro Workshop, 4th edition, discussant for “Flattening of the Phillips Curve: Causes and Their Policy Implications” by Chen Kan (2021).

CONFERENCES & EVENTS LOCAL ORGANIZING ACTIVITIES

- “International Conference on Central Bank Digital Currencies and Payment Systems”, *HKMA, AoF/HKIMR and HKUST* (2024).
- HKUST/Jinan Joint Macro Workshop, 6th–9th editions, *HKUST and Jinan University* (2023–2026).
- Hong Kong Junior Macro Workshop, 5th edition, *HKUST* (2022).
- “Cryptocurrencies, Blockchains and the Digital Economy”, *HKUST, Center for Economic Policy* (2022).
- “Central Bank Digital Currencies: Implementation, Applications and Challenges”, *HKUST, Center for Economic Policy* (2022).

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIP

Econometric Society; American Economic Association; European Economic Association; Societat Catalana d’Economia.

PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT

- Interviewee for CREACCIÓ / Observatori Socioeconòmic d'Osona, El 9 Nou and Osona.com, “El Talent Convidat” (2024). Digital media: [Web DOT - Talent Osona](#), [El 9 Nou](#), [Osona.com](#), [CREACCIÓ - Youtube](#).
- VOX EU.

LANGUAGES

Catalan (native), Spanish (native), English (proficient).